information about these dangers, yet instead of collaborating to find solutions, they are edging closer to a global war.

Would having even more information make things better – or worse? We will soon find out. Numerous corporations and governments are in a race to develop the most powerful information technology in history – AI. Some leading entrepreneurs, like the American investor Marc Andreessen, believe that AI will finally solve all of humanity's problems. On 6 June 2023, Andreessen published an essay titled 'Why AI Will Save the World', peppered with bold statements like 'I am here to bring the good news: AI will not destroy the world, and in fact may save it' and 'AI can make everything we care about better.' He concluded, 'The development and proliferation of AI – far from a risk that we should fear – is a moral obligation that we have to ourselves, to our children, and to our future.'[14]

Ray Kurzweil concurs, arguing in *The Singularity Is Nearer* that 'AI is the pivotal technology that will allow us to meet the pressing challenges that confront us, including overcoming disease, poverty, environmental degradation and all of our human frailties. We have a moral imperative to realize this promise of new technologies.' Kurzweil is keenly aware of the technology's potential perils, and analyzes them at length, but believes they could be mitigated successfully.[15]

Others are more skeptical. Not only philosophers and social scientists but also many leading AI experts and entrepreneurs like Yoshua Bengio, Geoffrey Hinton, Sam Altman, Elon Musk and Mustafa Suleyman have warned the public that AI could destroy our civilisation.[16] A 2024 article co-authored by Bengio, Hinton and numerous other experts noted that 'unchecked AI advancement could culminate in a large-scale loss of life and the biosphere, and the marginalization or even extinction of humanity'.[17] In a 2023 survey of 2,778 AI researchers, more than a third gave at least a 10 per cent chance of advanced AI leading to outcomes as bad as human extinction.[18] In 2023 close to thirty governments – including those of China, the United States and the UK – signed the Bletchley Declaration on AI, which acknowledged that 'there is potential for serious, even catastrophic, harm, either deliberate or unintentional, stemming from the most significant capabilities of these AI models'.[19] By using such apocalyptic terms, experts and governments have no wish to conjure a Hollywood image of rebellious robots running in the streets and shooting